in dealing with GOI [the government of India] re Korea," developments in Tibet would make India "reassess its views re character" of the regime in Beijing.[164]

Henderson warned Washington against giving the impression that it was trying to use the Tibet situation to sell India on alignment with the US. He further asserted, "If [a] rift should come [between China and India] … it should clearly come through force of events and not with help of outside powers."[165] Acheson subsequently instructed American officials not to appear to be trying to create a wedge between China and India.[166]

The Chinese invasion might not have caused a Sino-Indian split, but it did have an impact within India. A diplomat later noted the "deep anger" it generated.[167] In parliament, there was also anxiety about Chinese intentions and Indian preparedness on both the opposition and treasury benches.[168] Even some socialist politicians became disillusioned with China.[169] Within the government, officials like Bajpai altered their assessments—the invasion of Tibet showed that China did not really care about India's sensitivities. With Nehru's approval, Bajpai instructed Panikkar to tell Beijing that its use of force was harmful for Sino-Indian relations, as well as China's international position. Suggesting that China had misled it, India also sent an official note calling the Chinese action "deplorable."[170] After India received an accusatory response from China, Delhi responded defensively, denying that it had any ambitions in Tibet, but asserting that it had certain rights there.[171]

The invasion further fueled the Indian government's internal debate about China. The different perceptions of and proposed strategies toward that country were evident in a letter from Patel to Nehru and in the latter's subsequent note on Tibet. In Patel's view, which was closer to the dominant assessment in the US, the invasion showed that China represented both an internal and external threat to India. He asserted that Beijing was hoodwinking Delhi. Furthermore, China did not see India as a friend despite Delhi's recognition of the communist regime and its efforts to facilitate Beijing's seating at the UN. Patel argued that nothing India did to convince China of its good intentions would change the Chinese leadership's hostility toward India. Finally, he viewed China's behavior as that of a "potential enemy," one that was no longer separated by a Tibetan buffer and that in